

DER WONNEZEITSEGE

27. OSCHRET/04. WONNET, 2019



ZUFIEGE ZUM JOE MAREK UN ZUM BRIAN WEIS
REV - 0 - 2012

Honoring: Holle, Berchta, Gedreier Eckhart, Landwichde, Vorgenger (those who have gone before)

Die Aarufing

Intonation of the Runes

Each rune is intoned thrice: Haagel (Hagalaz), Fackel (Kenaz), Yaahr (Jera), Wunsch (Wunjo)

Die Heiliching

*Sichel, heilich daer Aldaar un die Schtell
Beschitzt uns mit der Graft vun de Ziewe
Bei Wudan un Frigg fer der Gemeeschaft zu baue
Bei Ziu un Zisa fer die Gerechdichkeit
un der Fruchsfriede zu erhalde
Bei Frey un Freya fer die Wohldaat zu beile
un zu sammle
Bei Dunner un Siwwa fer es Volk vollzumechtige.
Bei de Fraae Berchta un Holle fer es Volk
zu erneire
Wie schmittet der Hammer die Sichel,
So die Sichel der Hammer fiedert.
'S iss es Lewesraad, zu saehe un zu schneide
Sichel, heilich daer Aldaar un die Schtell!*

Heel!

Heel!

Heel!

*Sickle, make holy this altar and this site.
Protect us with the craft of the Deities
By Wudan and Frigg to build the community
By Ziu and Zisa to keep justice and frith

By Frey and Freya to cut and to gather
the bounty
By Dunner and Siwwa to empower the people
By the Ladies Berchta and Holle to renew
the people
As the Hammer forges the Sickle
So the Sickle feeds the Hammer
It is the Cycle of life, to sow and to reap
Sickle, make holy this altar and this site.*

Hail!

Hail!

Hail!

Unser Zweck - Our Purpose

Heit sammle mir uns do, fer unser Haerrinn Holle zu ehre.

Unseri Haerrin Holle iss die mild, doch mehdich, Beschitzerin vum Pennsilfaanisch Deitsch Volk. Mit der Weisheet, der Gnaad, un em Mitleid fiehrt die Holle uns darrich de Leweszeitte.

Heit sehne mir, as es Land bei ihrem Gefiehl erneirt iss.

Es Lewe schpringt ums ringsrum!

Losset uns zamme die Leweswonne feiere!

We are gathered here to honor our Lady Holle.

Holle is the mild, yet powerful, Protectoress of the Deitsch nation. With Wisdom, Grace, and Compassion, Holle guides us through the lifetimes.

Today we see that the Land is renewed by Her touch.

Life is springing all around us!

Let us celebrate the joy of life together!

Heel Holle!

Ahead of the Parade of Spirits is the noble Gedreier Eckhart, Loyal Eckhart. A figure from Germanic heroic legends, Eckhart provided a voice of prophecy to Hagen in the *Nibelungenslied*. Though not a god, he is said to have served Holle faithfully throughout his life, and She, as reward, has kept him in Her service in death. He walks ahead of the Wild Hunt, announcing the coming whirlwind and warning the folk to prepare for Holle's arrival. Behind Eckhart is the Parade of Spirits, coming to a close after wending its way among the realms, hunting the spirits of the departed.

As the Dark Half of the year yields to the Light Half, we thank Berchta for Her protection and guidance through the darkest times.

Der Aaruf - The Invocation

Liewi Haerrin Holle!

Mir bidde Dich mit uns zu bsuche

Un mit uns heit die Wonne zu feiere

Sei unser verehrter Gaschtin

un unseri Freindschaft verdeele.

Heele!

Dear Lady Holle

We bid Thee to visit with us

And to celebrate the joyous time with us today

Be our honored Guest

And share in our community.

Hail!

*Liewi Haerrin Berchta
Mir bedanke uns Dich
fer Dei Hilf un Verwaahring
Sei unser verehrter Gaschtin
un unseri Freindschaft verdeele.*

*Dear Lady Berchta
We thank Thee
For Thy help and protection
Be our honored Guest
And share in our community.*

Heele!

Hail!

*Gedrier Eckhart
Der Yacht ihre Schtimm
Er, der geht vor
Gedreier im Lewe, Gedreier im Dood
Heit errinere mir uns an dich*

*Loyal Eckhart
The voice of the Hunt
He who goes before
Loyal in Life, Loyal in Death
Today we remember thee.*

Heele!

Hail!

Es Opfer un Die Eed - Offerings and Oaths

*Losst uns enniche Opfer uff der Aldaar adder in 's Feier yetz schtelle
Un wann ennichebber hot en Eed zu bschweere, kumm yetz voraa.*

*If anyone has any offerings, please place them onto the altar, or, later, into the fire.
If anyone has any oaths to take, come forward now.*

Eed/ Oaths: *Any oaths should be cleared with the ritual's leadership prior to public expression.*

Die Heiliching vun de Opfer - Hallowing of the Offerings

*Zu Eich, Liewe Haerrine Holle un Berchta
Mir hewwe die Seidel aa
Mir biede Met un Seider aa
Un gewwe die do annere Gschenker
Wie 'n Zeichnis zu unserer Dankbaarkeet
un vun unserer Gemeeschaft
Darrich Eich binne mir uns fescht aa
Losst 's immer so sei!*

*To Ye, Dear Ladies Holle and Berchta
We lift the Stein
We offer mead and cider
And give these other gifts
As a symbol of our gratitude
And of our community
Through Ye we bind ourselves fast
May it always be so!*

Heel Holle!
 Heel Berchta!
 Heel zu de Ziewe!
 Heel Eckhart!
 Heel zu de Vorgenger!
 Heel zu de Noochkummer!
 Heel zu de Landwichde!
 Heel die Gemeeschaft!

Hail Holle!
 Hail Berchta!
 Hail to the deities!
 Hail Eckhart!
 Hail to the ancestors!
 Hail to the descendants!
 Hail to the Landwights!
 Hail to the community!

Die Ausdeeling - The Distribution

Sing Heel Dir Holle

Der Sege - The Blessing

When pouring the libations, all say (choose either language):

Vun de Ziewe zu der Erd zu uns
 Vun uns zu der Erd zu de Gedder

*From the gods to the Earth to us
 From us to the Earth to the gods*

'N Gschenk fer 'n Gschenk
 Heele!

*A gift for a gift.
 Hail!*

Zum Schluss - In Closing

Heit beginne mir en neis Wonefescht
 un baue do en sctandhafliches Bindnis zamme
 Mit de Ziewe
 Un darrich unserer allgemee Zweck
 Losst uns zamme immer sctarricker waxe.
 Der Sege iss beschlosse waerre.

*Today we begin a new festival of joy
 and build here a steadfast alliance together
 with the Deities
 And through our common purpose
 Let us all grow stronger together.
 This Sege is closed.*

Zu de Wichde - To The Wights

Mir gewwe aa en Opfer zu de Wichde
 Vun desem Land
 Un mir bedanke uns 'ne
 Fer ihrer Schirm

*We give also an offering to the Wights
 of this Land
 And we are thankful to them
 For their protection*

Heel!

Hail!

Die Aarufing

Ich ruf zu mitleidiche Grefde vun der Nadde, vun der Erd, vun em Schtee

Mit der Ruhzeit im Hatz

Kummt doch her, gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmlich mit Erdgraft sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich Naddwind in uns!

Ich ruf zu mitleidiche Grefde vun em Oscht, vun der Luft, un em Sunnuff

Mit Yungezeit im Hatz

Kummt doch her, gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmlich mit Luftgraft sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich Oschtwind in uns!

Ich ruf zu mitleidiche Grefde vun der Sudde, vun em Summer, un em Feier

mit Leidenschaft im Hatz

Kummt doch her, gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmliche mit Feier sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich Suddwind in uns!

Ich ruf zu mitleidiche Grefde vun em Wescht, vun em Wasser, un Schpotyaahr

Mit Heemgezeit im Hatz

Kummt doch her gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmlich mit em Wasser sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich Weschtwind in uns!

Ich ruf zu de mitleidiche Graft vun em Himmel, vun em Schepfer, vun em Schtanne

Mit der Umwandleheet im Hatz

Kumm doch her, gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmlich mit em Himmel sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich Himmelwind in uns!

Ich ruf die mitleidiche Graft hie vun unich der Erd, der Geischthieling

Mit Freindschaft im Hatz

Kummt doch her, gebt uns Helf un Verwaahring

Losset uns mitstimmlich mit de Voreldere sei

Liewe Ziewe! Fliesst darrich es Gebliet in uns!

The Invocation

I call upon the compassionate powers of the north, of the earth, of the stone with the time of rest in heart

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the powers of earth.

The dear gods and goddesses through the northwind in us.

I call upon the compassionate powers of the east of the air, of the sunrise with the time of youth in heart.

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the powers of air.

The dear gods and goddesses through the eastwind in us.

I call upon the compassionate powers of the south, of the summer, and the fire, with passion in Heart

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the powers of fire.

The dear gods and goddesses through the southwind in us.

I call upon the compassionate powers of the west, of the water, and autumn, with the return to home in heart

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the powers of water.

The dear gods and goddesses through the westwind in us.

I call upon the compassionate powers of the heavens, of the creator, of the stars, transformation in heart

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the powers of the heavens.

The dear gods and goddesses through the heavenwind in us.

I call the compassionate powers here from under the earth, the spiritcave (dwelling of the ancestral spirits), with our lineage (vorbearers, ancestors) in heart

Come here to this place, give us help and protection, let us be harmonious with the ancestors.

The dear gods and goddesses through the blood (family) in us.

Hail!

Discussion Topics

- This is one of the highest holidays on the Urglaawe calendar. It is frequently known as Walpurgisnacht, but, since Walburga was a Christian missionary, the terms Wonnennacht or Hexennacht are more appropriate.
- Significance comes to us through Heathen, through Braucherei lore, and other Deutsch folklore.
- The night of April 30 into May 1 is observance of the return of Holle from the Furious Host (Wild Hunt) that began on Allelieweziel (31. Gehling/October) to the soil. Her return brings the land to back to full life. Note that Urglaawe "days" begin the night before, so the night of April 30 is actually May 1. Thus, Wonnennacht is May Day. There is a distinct relationship between the return of Holle and the May Day celebrations of fertility.
- Holle is likely a member of the Wane (Vanir) tribe of the deities, if such tribes exist (Deutsch lore is unclear on this point). Some mythology indicates Her consort as Holler, who may be Ewicher Yeeger seen in Deutsch lore.
- Holle is a well-known and proactive deity within Urglaawe and Braucherei. She plays an active role in the birth-life-death-rebirth cycle, including protecting the souls of the deceased until they are ready for the next life. She is associated with anything cyclical or spiral.
- Time-cord work in Braucherei and mythic imagery carry knowledge of Holle putting souls through Her Mill to prepare for the rebirth of the parts of the soul that are reborn. The soul is seen to have twelve parts, at least one of which is reborn into a subsequent generations. Some say that this is why people feel sometimes like a new acquaintance is so familiar.
- In some parts of Europe, this is a night to dress in costume and burn effigies of witches (a Christian image). We, of course, view this differently and it is not a matter of evil but of spirituality. Many events related to the Furious Host involve costumes (Halloween, King Frost, Belsnickel, Mummers, Mardis Gras, and perhaps even the roots of the April Fool. Did you ever notice how all these costume events disappear after the end of April? They all represent the parade of spirits that is now over. Walpurgisnacht itself is a Christian term, so we are gradually encouraging utilizing "Wonnennacht" ("Joy Night") instead.
- In Deutsch lore, on April 30 and May 1, people open all their doors and their windows to the home and hang a sign over the doorway. The sign reads, "WALBURGA" or "HOLLE" and welcomes Holle into the home.
- The fairy tale of *Frau Holle* indicates that She likes an orderly, clean home. The concept of "spring cleaning," at least among the Deutsch, has its origins in the time of preparation for Her arrival. Spring cleaning is initiated at Grundsaudaag with the cleaning of the hearth and is to be concluded by Walpurgisnacht. Brauchers move items out of halls and remove clutter from the path at this time (alas, I am remiss in this effort, though I keep trying!).
- It is safe to put frost-hardy plants into the ground, but Deutsch lore says that frost-sensitive plants should wait until the daytime of May 15. Three Frost Giants pass through on May 13, 14, and 15 (See "Twelve Nights of the Wonnendanz" below).
- The lore gives these frost giants' names as Dreizehdax ("thirteen badger", Vatzehvedder ("fourteen quill" (porcupine)), and Fuffzehfux ("fifteen fox"). These same Giants appear as scouts for King Frost in November.

Seasonal Focus

Walpurgisnacht to Midsummer: Experience the joy of life, including the joy of planting new life in the ground. Make the planting a spiritual, loving event. Revel in friends, family, kindred, hobbies, and things you enjoy. Moifescht (May Day) is also the observance of male creative energies.

Keep in mind that days in Urglaawe practice begin at sundown. Thus, sundown on Thursday, April 30 (Dunnerschdaag, 30. Oschdret), is actually the beginning of Friday, May 1 (Freidaag, 1. Wonnet).

Mitleid - This is the virtue of Compassion. The concept is different from the modern era understanding of this word, however. The focus of Mitleid is that of an appropriate compassion for others who are in a position through no fault of their own or who have seen their errors and are attempting to correct them. Compassion for irresponsibility is detrimental to the whole of the community. However, equally detrimental is providing no path to redemption for those who are trying to straighten themselves out. They become stuck in a quagmire of their mistakes, even if they are striving to distance themselves from their prior behavior. In some cases, the compassion is towards those who have experienced a loss or a tragedy. This may include a loss of employment or losses incurred in a natural disaster, etc. Each year, Urglaawe organizations hold a food drive at Erntfescht. Filling the local food banks can help the wider community. These are gifts in exchange for the gifts we have in our lives. They are voluntary and free of compulsion. Also, we never know whether we may be in need of such assistance ourselves someday.

We should take careful consideration of the errors or crimes and the efforts the individual is taking to correct his/her ways. Mitleid can result in our lending a hand, when feasible in order to help strengthen our community overall.

The folk tale of *Frau Holle* provides some insight into the Germanic understanding of the importance of Mitleid. The mistreated stepdaughter falls into a well and awakens in Holle's meadow. The girl encounters some bread that is baking in an oven and will soon burn if not removed. The girl dutifully removes the bread.

She then encounters an apple tree, the branches of which are heavy with apples. The girl shakes the tree to lighten its load. Holle rewards these compassionate acts, along with other virtuous behavior, by covering the girl in gold before sending her back to her family. Conversely, her lazy stepsister, who lacks virtue consistently throughout the tale, is covered in pitch.

Verwandschaft: The virtue of Kinship reflects the need that all of us have to belong to a community. Despite the efforts of the consumer culture to separate and divide people in order to increase corporate bottom lines, it is unnatural for humans not to live and to exist in a social setting. Kinship, along with other virtues, can help to create an environment of security, trust, and interdependence among the members of a community. Even while we embrace Self-Reliance (*Selbschtzuverdraue*), we also embrace that community interdependence, which is reflected in the Heathen concepts of gift exchanges and frith.

Twelve Nights of the Wonnedanz and the Wonnezeit Myth

WONNENACHT AND THE WONNEDANZ

As Sunna's kiss brought increasing warmth and light to the Hatzholz (Heartwood; the physical realm), Holle sent for her ever-loyal servant, Gedreier Eckhart, whose job it was to walk ahead of the Parade of Spirits to warn the living of the fury behind him. Eckhart's love for Holle is as great in death as it was in life, so he flew into the midst of the Host, finding the goddess dressed in white and seated in a wagon being pulled by the souls of nine bulls. The wagon rolled on three great spinning wheels. From each wheel spun a multicolored thread that wove with the the thread from the others, forming a sack of infinite size named Immerraum ("always-room"). The thunderous voices of many found spirits within the sack filled resounded across the heavens.

"I have filled the sack that cannot be filled, and it is time to bring them home," Holle said. "Go forth to Mannheem (the home of humanity within the Hatzholz) and tell the living that they may welcome the Host and that they should be prepared for the visit. Those who remembered and honored my word will be rewarded. After the visit, they are to light two fires and to pass between them. Through that action, they will be renewed. Then you are to go to the Mannheem field, where you will find a lone linden tree under which you may rest until I arrive."

As Eckhart began his journey into the Hatzholz, announcing the return of the Great Lady, Holle took her mighty Sichel (Sickle) and cut the three threads each, using the end of the strands to tie the sack shut.

The Host crossed from the Oschtbledder (Eastern Leaves) into the Hatzholz. Throngs of people, though scared at first, came out to welcome the parade, honoring the arrival of the wondrous Lady. The clamor of spirits filled the high skies as Holle entered Mannheem. The bulls pulled Her wagon through open windows and doors, seeking those who welcomed Her. The orderly homes served as a sign that Her command was obeyed. She filled the homes with bright light that brought such joy to the residents that they broke out in song and dance.

Presently the wagon approached the Mannheem field called Hexefeld, where Holle found Eckhart sleeping within the bark of a linden tree. She sent the southwest wind, Riffel, to awaken him. She instructed Eckhart to lead the Host to Hexefeld and, upon arrival, to cut loose the spirits in the sack. "It is time to meet my sister," she stated.

Eckhart did as he was told. As the Host of the cosmic spirits approached the field, Eckhart saw another parade descending from the clouds, emerging from the forests, and coming from the soil. Ahead of this parade was a brilliant gray light radiating from a beautiful elderly woman who was also dressed in white. Eckhart approached the woman, recognizing Her as Berchta, and he bowed before Her. He then took the lead through the countryside as the two parades merged together and drew closer to the linden tree where Holle awaited them.

A hush fell upon the Host as the two sisters greeted one another. They embraced, and they began to spin in a dance. The dance spun gentle whirlwinds that touched the Host, bringing warmth and joy to the spirits of the Host, and they, too, began to dance. Some gathered strands and dust from the sack, streaming the strands around trees and scattering the dust on the ground.

The Sisters continued to dance with the Host dancing behind them, moving from the field and over the rivers and lakes. Every being in the water began to dance for joy. The whirlwinds spawned gentle rains that awakened the spirits in the sleeping plants, and they, too, began to dance for joy.

The Dance moved to the foothills, where the Frost Giants had taken refuge from Sunna's breath. As the Host approached, the winter vanished, forcing the Frost Giants to retreat.

On the twelfth day, Holle instructed Eckhart to sleep in a rock at the base of a mountain pillar while the dance continued up a ridge called Hexenkopf. The entourage eventually stopped by a marshy wellspring near the top. The two sisters took rest by the wellspring, and the spirits began to feel drawn to its depths (2).

Holle and Berchta commanded the Host to continue their journey to its end by Holle's home.

Holle led one half of the parade to an elder bush, the roots of which reached beyond the Hatzholz and into the dark realms, taking nourishment from three creeks named Schprudlendi, Gwellendi, and Fliessendi (3). Berchta led the other half to the depths of the wellspring, which emptied into the same creeks.

THE MILL

The spirits followed the goddesses into these creeks and surfaced in the Holle's meadow, named Bollwies (Flax Meadow), in the Dunkelgegend (4). The spirits followed the goddesses through some woods, passing Holle's home, Es Heisli. They soon entered an open field called Weiwerfeld and soon approached Her Mill.

Holle unhitched the bulls from Her wagon and yoked them to a giant millstone named Seelbrecher ("Soul Crusher"). Behind Berchta, the spirits lined up and entered the Mill, where they would be split apart, never to return in their present form. Holle returned to the joyous Mannheem, taking Her seat upon the Hexenkopf pillar while Eckhart sleeps in a rock. (5)

BERCHTA LEADS FORTHCOMING SOULS TO UNNERGEGEND

On the other end of the mill, the kernel of the selves of each soul emerged behind Berchta, who then led them up the world tree to the Unnergegend. There they take full form and await their return to the living realms.(6)

Thus, the Bright Half of the Year began and order was restored to Mannheim. King Frost, fearful of losing his grip on the valuable realm, sent his armies to attack (7).

(Note 1: in this story, the wind is coming from the southwest; in another myth, the wind directions are known by their destination rather than their origin. Thus, it is possible that the southwest wind in this myth is known by the name of the northeast wind in the other myth).

(Note 2: Magnetite was common at Hexenkopf and was eventually mined. The most familiar ponds at Hexenkopf currently are ore holes resulting from the mines, but there are also marshy water holes naturally on the mountain that may serve as the reference to the wellspring).

(Note 3: The names of the wells translate to Brimming, Bubbling, and Flowing)

(Note 4: The Dark Realm)

(Note 5: There are reports of a White Lady approaching walkers, carriages, and cars along the top of the pillar, particularly around Walpurgisnacht).

(Note 6: There is more to this segment to appear in the next version).

(Note 7: This is a connection to the Butzemann traditions and the myth of Dunner and the three Frost Giants, Dreizehdax, Vatzehvedder, and Fuffzehfux. At least two versions story have been described frequently under separate cover but will be harmonized either in the next version of this myth or in a separate myth).

Es Hollelied

**Heel Dir, Holle, ed'li Mudder
Heel Dir Holle, hohi Fraa
Seele sinne dief im Wasser
Seele sinne dief im See
Fedderflocke falle sietsam
Fedderflocke falle g'lind
Geb uns gudi Arewet heit un
Geb uns gudi Arewet nau
Glitzerend scheine die do Flocke,
Glitzerend scheint der Schnee im Land.
Baad mich mol yetz in Deim Brunn do
Der Brunn bringt mich in Dei Land.**

ROUGH ENGLISH TRANSLATION

**Hail Thee, Holle, noble mother,
Hail Thee, Holle, high woman.
Souls are sensing deep in the water,
Souls are sensing deep in the sea.
Feather flakes are falling softly,
Feather flakes are falling mildly.
Give us good work today,
Give us good work now.
Glittering shine these flakes,
Glittering shines the snow on the land.
Bathe me in your well, well brings me to your land.**

ORIGINAL GERMAN

Heil Dir, Holle, lehre Mutter,

Heil Dir, Holle, hohe Frau.

Seelen sinnen tief im Wasser,

Seelen sinnen tief im See.

Federflocken fallen leise,

Federflocken fallen lind.

Gib uns gute Arbeit heute,

Gib uns gute Arbeit nun.

Schillernd scheinen deine Flocken,

Schillernd scheint der Schnee im Land.

Bade mich in Deinem Brunnen,

Brunnen bringt mich in Dein Land.

Original German by Birgit Knorr

First public performance: Urglaawe rite to Holle, Trothmoot, 2013

